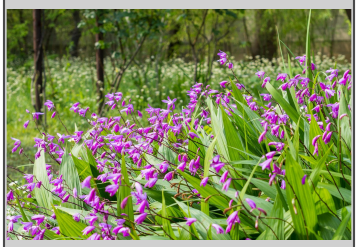
*Bletilla striata

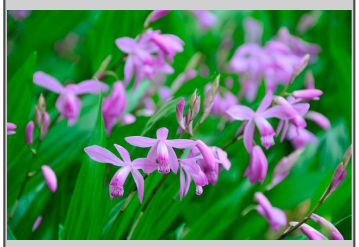
Chinese ground orchid, Hardy orchid, Hyacinth orchid

Family: Orchidaceae

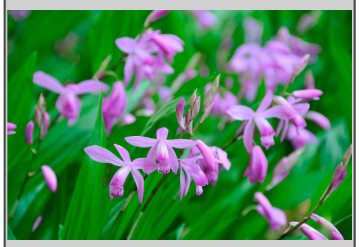
Passage N_S: 50 **TOTAL 50**



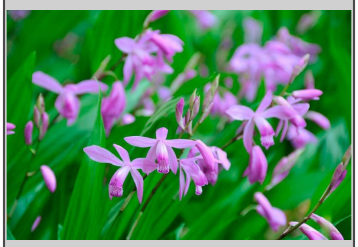
HABIT



OTHER



OTHER



FLOWER

QUICK FACTS

Plant Type: Not stated

Evergreen or deciduous
Deciduous

Growth & Size
Rate: Not stated
Size: 12–24 in (30–60 cm) tall × 6–18 in (15–45 cm) wide.
Clump-forming from pseudobulbs.
Spreads slowly by rhizomes

Sun

Water

Soil
Organically rich, moist, well-drained. Humus-rich, loamy. Slightly acidic to neutral. Improve drainage with organic matter or grit. Woodland floor type

Zone 8a
Hardy Zones 5–9. Suitable for Atlanta Zone 8a. Reliable perennial in part shade with moist, well-drained, organic-rich soil. Dies back in winter; mulch beneficial. Heat-tolerant in shade. One of the best hardy terrestrial orchids for the region

ORIGIN AND CHARACTERISTICS

Origin
Native to China, Japan, Tibet. Grassy slopes, mountain areas

Form
Terrestrial orchid. Herbaceous perennial. Clumping, erect. Deciduous (dies to ground in winter). One of the few hardy garden orchids. Easy terrestrial orchid for gardens.
RHS Award of Garden Merit

Foliage
Pleated, sword-shaped, ribbed, slender green leaves.
Thin- textured. Die back in winter

Flowers and fruit
Pink to purplish-pink (sometimes white) fragrant orchid-shaped flowers, ~5 cm wide, on erect stems.
Late spring to early summer. Attractive

Bark
Not applicable

PLANTING NOTES

Establishment

Low to medium maintenance. Plant pseudobulbs 2–4 in deep in spring. Mulch in winter. Divide in early spring when large. Excellent for shade borders, woodland edges, containers. Naturalizes modestly. Protect new shoots from late freezes

HEALTH

Health

Virtually disease-free. Watch for aphids, whitefly, mealybugs. Pseudobulb rot in wet winter soils. New growth vulnerable to late frosts. RHS AGM. No serious problems when well-drained

Symptoms

None stated